



NBC news reporter Robert Kovacik embraces people at St. John Eudes Parish during a vigil for crash victims.

TRUMP BANNING MS NOW, CNN AND POLITICO

Deeming the outlets ‘fake news,’ president says he will bar access to the White House.

BY STEPHEN BATTAGLIO

President Trump declared Friday that he is banning CNN, MS NOW and Politico from the White House “effective immediately,” an extraordinary escalation in his ongoing feud with the news media.

The action marks the latest salvo in a campaign against the media that has already won him multimillion-dollar settlements from two networks, put ABC’s broadcast licenses under federal review and kept the Associated Press out of the Oval Office for more than a year. It also tests how far the courts will let a president go in deciding who gets to cover him.

In a statement on Truth Social, Trump attacked the reporting of the three outlets, which he described as “FAKE NEWS!”

“Media Outlets shouldn’t be able to constantly write or report FICTION and LIES when they’re covering the President of the United States of America,” Trump said.

How a ban would be enacted remains to be seen. Based on Trump’s past clashes with the press, barring the outlets from the White House is unlikely to stand up to a legal challenge. In 2018, the White House tried to ban journalist Jim Acosta, then working for CNN, but a court ordered that his press credential be restored.

It was unclear whether the ban would apply only to White House press briefings or would bar all access to the White House grounds.

Last year, the Trump White House issued a ban on the Associated Press when the news organization refused to recognize the president’s renaming of the Gulf of Mexico by executive order. A federal judge ordered that the AP’s access to the White House be restored on the grounds that the government cannot punish a journalistic outlet over the content of its speech.

A divided appeals court panel later paused that ruling for the Oval Office, Air Force One and other restricted spaces, allowing the White House to keep the AP out of them while the case proceeds.

Trump’s remarks generated an immediate outcry from press freedom groups.

“It’s difficult to imagine a [See Media, A12]

Driver charged in fatal crash had drug history

Woman accused of striking bus has been in and out of custody as she battled addiction, her friend says

BY HANNAH FRY AND RICHARD WINTON

It looked like another afternoon commute at the bustling intersection of De Soto Avenue and Nordhoff Street on Tuesday when Metro Bus Line 166 crossed into the intersection.

Cars in opposing traffic lanes were stopped. Suddenly, a 2004 Ford Expedition barreled into the intersection from the wrong direction at a high rate of speed, slamming into the middle of the bus. The impact was so powerful it hurled a passenger onto the street and lodged the front of the SUV into the bus’ frame. There were no signs the driver braked in the moments before the collision, video footage of the incident shows.

The crash began an evening of death in Chatsworth. Two passengers aboard the

bus were killed and six others were hurt. It was a big story — one that drew TV news helicopters. About two hours after the crash, an NBC4 helicopter covering the incident suddenly fell from the sky and burst into flames a few blocks away. A journalist and pilot on board and a bystander on the ground were killed.

The driver of the Expedition, Bailee Lynn Rios, was charged on Thursday with reckless driving, driving under the influence and two counts of second-degree murder in the deaths of 46-year-old Daniel Castillo and 31-year-old Gage Weida, who was ejected from the bus in the crash. Rios was not charged in connection with the helicopter crash.

Court records and interviews paint a picture of Rios as a woman who has long struggled with drug addiction.

She was arrested several

times but was never sentenced to jail time, Ventura County Superior Court records show. Instead, she was given probation and ordered to go into drug treatment programs on at least three occasions, records show.

Diversion programs for drug offenses were not unusual at the time under Proposition 47, which passed in 2014 and reclassified simple possession of controlled substances cases from felonies to misdemeanors, according to legal experts. The goal, advocates say, was to get individuals struggling with addiction treatment while reducing overcrowding inside state prisons.

Rios’ friend, Lanise Ward, told The Times in an interview that Rios was sober when the two met for lunch about a month ago. She had been going to Narcotics Anonymous meetings and had been clean for the [See Driver, A9]

California tech has turned the old-fashioned into fashionable

Thrifty clothes are trending thanks to Silicon Valley

BY ANNIKA DUNEJA

Thrifty clothes have become an unlikely fashion flex for Hollywood’s haute couture hoarders and other trend-setters.

California companies have propelled this movement, turning what was once an old-fashioned way to save money into a booming industry at the cutting edge of style.

The secondhand clothing market grew 20% to more than \$240 billion over the last five years, according to McKinsey & Co.’s State of

Fashion report, as San Francisco’s RealReal, Redwood City’s Poshmark, Oakland’s ThredUp and others used Silicon Valley innovation to streamline listing, finding and delivering secondhand products.

“Resale itself reflects something very Californian: taking an existing behavior and using technology to fundamentally change its scale and possibilities,” said Rati Sahi Levesque, founder of the RealReal. “What we’ve done is build the trust, logistics, data and technology that allow that behavior to become a mainstream way

millions of people shop.”

The emergence of a new kind of online shopper, using these sites and willing to pay luxury prices for used pieces, has become so prominent that it is sometimes outshining the freshest runway trends.

California consumers’ acceptance of and excitement about thrifty, recycled and repurposed clothes catapulted L.A.’s Reformation from a vintage boutique into a billion-dollar company after its initial public offering last month.

Online thrifters like that [See Thrift, A12]

Newsom order on AI safety urges ‘kill switch’

Creating new panel, he endorses safeguard against rogue actions he once rejected.

BY DAKOTA SMITH AND QUEENIE WONG

SACRAMENTO — California Gov. Gavin Newsom on Friday became the latest politician to push for stronger artificial intelligence regulations following claims from AI experts that the technology could lead to widespread death and destruction.

Newsom issued an executive order for the creation of a panel to recommend safety rules, including the development of a possible “kill switch” for AI programs that go rogue.

It was a striking turn for the governor, who two years ago vetoed a bill that would have required AI companies to develop such a switch.

Connor Leahy, U.S. executive director of the non-profit ControlAI, said Newsom’s order shows “the conversation on AI is changing so quickly.”

“It’s becoming extremely clear that action is desperately needed,” said Leahy.

Newsom’s order comes a day after Pennsylvania Gov. Josh Shapiro made a similar plea for AI safeguards, including third-party oversight and greater transparency.

Some Democratic and Republican leaders around the country are scrambling to come up with regulations after employees at AI companies recently warned that the technology could create catastrophe, including the end of humanity.

Reps. Ted Lieu (D-Torance) and Nathaniel Moran (R-Texas) introduced a bill in July that would have required developers to have the capability to shut down powerful AI systems. The act also would have given federal officials the ability to intervene in systems that can cause harm.

TechNet, which represents leaders of major technology firms, remains committed to working with Newsom. [See Newsom, A5]

Anthropic model building successor

Company says it will share metrics with public and encourages others to follow suit. BUSINESS, A11

Americans want safety; he doesn’t

President Trump ignores growing concerns about risks of AI, writes Anita Chabria. CALIFORNIA, B1

Chancellor ignites free speech dispute

UCLA chief’s remarks on 9/11 forum wrongly implied it endorsed terrorism, critics say.

BY JAWEED KALEEM

A public message from UCLA Chancellor Julio Frenk distancing the university from a law school 9/11 symposium that included a lawyer for the alleged “mastermind” of the attack has ignited an intensifying outcry among UC faculty and hundreds of academics nationwide over what they see as a high-level infringement on academic freedom.

In letters to Frenk this week, dozens of UCLA School of Law faculty demanded a retraction and called Frenk’s statement “not befitting of a leader.” More than 250 signatories to a nationwide open letter that included professors at Harvard and Stanford also called for a retraction.

The influential leaders of UCLA’s Academic Senate sent a more measured letter



PAUL KURODA For The Times
SOME professors backed Chancellor Julio Frenk.

to Frenk about their “concerns and reservations,” urging administrators and faculty to work together to uphold academic freedom.

The Sept. 10-11 symposium in question examined the legal consequences of the U.S. response to the attacks, including torture, detention and government surveillance. Right-leaning media criticized its inclusion of a Defense Department lawyer who represented alleged 9/11 mastermind Khalid Sheikh Mohammed and a speaker from the Council on American-Is [See Backlash, A9]

Coaster was a thrill. Then came injuries

BY FEDOR ZARKHIN

Six Flags Magic Mountain has long considered itself “The Thrill Capital of the World,” a competitive title in a world of extreme amusement parks vying to be the biggest, baddest and most intense.

And the X2 ride has for years been the Valencia park’s crown jewel, the first roller coaster in the world that spun riders 360 degrees in their seats.

“There’s no other coaster quite like it,” said Derek Perry, a spokesperson for the American Coaster Enthusiasts organization. “X2 is the one that people run to.”

But X2 has come under close inspection after several lawsuits allege people were injured on the ride. Six Flags shut down X2 in July

amid a state investigation into the coaster. The state agency that inspects amusement parks, Cal/OSHA, did not respond to questions about the investigation or when it might be complete because it’s ongoing.

One mother who has been living with the grief of losing her son was “sickened” to hear that more injuries occurred this year, four years after her son died shortly after riding X2.

“It’s so beyond anything that should ever happen,” Anne Hawley said.

Hawley’s son Christopher was 22 on June 23, 2022, when he and his brother rode X2, billed by the park as “a [rite] of passage for the ultimate daredevil.” He had trouble walking immediately after getting off, then quickly lost consciousness. Doctors found severe brain [See Coaster, A8]

UFW mainstay Chatfield dies

Figure in farmworkers union helped secure safe spaces for Sacramento’s homeless community. CALIFORNIA, B1

Trump invokes Willie Horton ad

President refers to Black man from racist 1988 campaign ad while stumping in North Carolina. NATION, A4

Weather

Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 84/67. B3



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

FOREIGN OWNERS CLEARED

FCC grants a request to allow Middle Eastern royal families to hold a substantial stake in a Paramount-Warner Bros. merger. BUSINESS, A10